

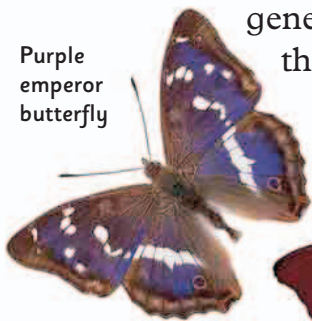
Butterflies and moths

Butterflies and moths are unique insects because their wings are covered in tiny scales. They look alike but there are a few slight differences.

Which is which?

Butterflies have club-shaped antennae, or feelers, and moths tend to have feathery or plain antennae. Butterflies are also generally more colourful than moths.

Purple emperor butterfly



Red glider butterfly



Eighty-eight butterfly



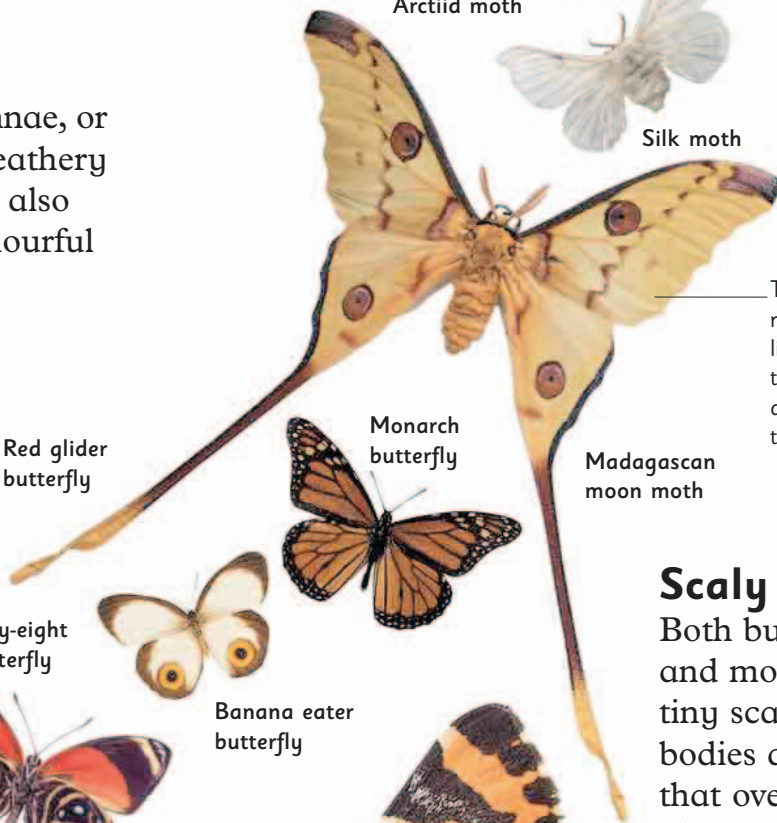
Banana eater butterfly



Monarch butterfly



Madagascan moon moth



There are now no silk moths left in the wild – they are all bred to make silk.

Silk moth



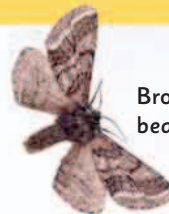
Arctiid moth



Hartig's brahmaea moth



Brown brindled beauty moth



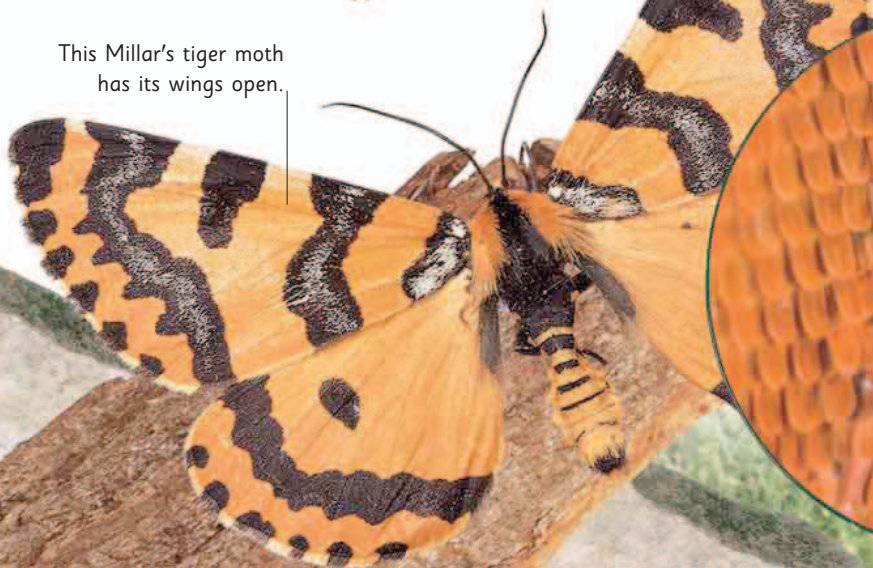
Resting

Butterflies come out by day and moths emerge at night. When moths rest they open their wings, while butterflies rest with their wings closed.

Scaly skins

Both butterflies and moths have tiny scales on their bodies and wings that overlap like tiles on a roof.

This Millar's tiger moth has its wings open.



This peacock butterfly has its wings closed.

